



YOU HAVE A CHOICE.

Roberts Creeks Area D All Candidates Meeting

Scott Tilley's Remarks

Monday, October 5, 2026 | 6:30-8:30 p.m. | Roberts Creek Hall

Opening Statement

Good evening, and thank you for being here.

We are gathered on the traditional territories of the shíshálh Nation and the Squamish Nation. Reconciliation begins with understanding whose territories we are on, recognizing our responsibilities here, and respecting Indigenous self-determination. Roberts Creek's OCP names our own commitment in its first objective: **"to ensure the right of self-determination."** We can only stand behind that principle if we respect the self-determination of the Nations whose territories we are on.

I have spoken with former Area D directors, sitting directors and candidates to understand the stewardship of this office. Roberts Creek's OCP is an example of community priorities carried forward beyond any one director's term. That continuity is what gives Roberts Creek its agency.

The candidates before you may share many of the same priorities. The difference may be how we do the work. Kelly has emphasized direct advocacy, relationships across government, and listening to experienced staff. Those are valuable tools, and I would use them too. I would also help build the processes that turn clear direction from the elected Board into practical plans and measures of progress. Relationships can move work forward now; plans and feedback help the organization retain what works as people change.

The Area D Director must bring Roberts Creek's priorities to the Board, work with all nine directors to advance regional issues, and protect local agency. We cannot solve water, housing, transportation or emergency resilience in a bubble.

I respect the service past and current directors have given. I want to strengthen the systems that keep good work going as people change, and leave the next director a stronger foundation to build on. As you listen tonight, consider not only the answers, but how each candidate would turn priorities into lasting progress.

YOU HAVE A CHOICE.

Question 1: Priorities

What do you see as the three most important issues facing Roberts Creek? What specific actions would you take as Area D Director to address those issues during your four-year term? If you are the incumbent, how does your record to date inform the actions you would take in your next term?

YOUR RESPONSE

I see three connected priorities for Roberts Creek: water, affordable housing, and protecting our community's agency through good planning.

First, water. We need dependable supply and a clearer understanding of the watershed, aquifers, drainage and infrastructure we rely on. I would work with the Board, First Nations, the Province, water users and local experts to develop an overarching water-management plan, with monitoring and clear milestones, then use that evidence in growth and infrastructure decisions.

Second, housing. Changing zoning does not build homes if the process remains uncertain, slow or too costly. I would work with the Board and staff, housing providers and applicants to identify those barriers, set clear service expectations, and make it easier for projects that meet community goals to move forward.

Third, Roberts Creek's voice. I would work through the OCPC and my liaison role to carry local priorities into regional planning, while building support across the Board on issues that cross community boundaries.

Across all three, my approach is to set clear goals, use the SCRD's existing tools, work with the right people early, track progress and report back to residents.

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Question 2: Roberts Creek OCP and Community-Specific Policies

The SCRD is currently undertaking an OCP Renewal Project that is considering how the existing community plans can be integrated into a new regional framework. Roberts Creek currently has its own OCP and an Official Community Plan Commission (OCPC), with the Area Director designated as the liaison between the OCPC and the SCRD. How would you ensure that the policies, values and characteristics specific to Roberts Creek are maintained and meaningfully represented in the new OCP? Do you support maintaining the role of the Roberts Creek OCPC and the Area Director's liaison role?

YOUR RESPONSE

Yes. I support maintaining the Roberts Creek OCPC and the Area Director's liaison role.

The first objective of our current OCP is "to ensure the right of self-determination." That should guide the renewal. A regional framework can make planning more consistent, but the Roberts Creek OCP should remain the foundation for policies that apply here. Regional consistency should help address shared issues while respecting Roberts Creek's agency, character, values and infrastructure realities.

I would involve the OCPC throughout the process, bring its recommendations to the Board, and work with the other directors to build support for Roberts Creek's priorities within the regional plan while listening to their needs. I would report back clearly on how the recommendations were considered and what decisions followed.

The OCPC will need support as this work moves ahead. Its elections are in November, and I encourage residents to consider joining. The renewal will benefit from a wider range of local experience and ideas.

That is how we preserve meaningful local direction while working with the wider SCRD on a coherent regional plan.

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Question 3: Environmental Protection and Development

What steps would you support to ensure that streams, wetlands, riparian areas, groundwater, drainage systems and neighbouring properties are adequately protected when development applications are considered?

YOUR RESPONSE

Environmental protection and resilient development start with consistently using the tools and knowledge we already have.

Development reviews, including MoTI subdivision processes, can produce geotechnical, riparian, drainage and flood-risk reports that identify environmental sensitivities, hazards and mitigation. When later development applications reference that work, the SCRD should make sure the reports are actually in its file, understand their recommendations, and carry applicable measures into clear, enforceable permit conditions.

If a report is missing, unclear or inconsistent with other information, resolve that before approving the application. Then follow through and confirm that required mitigation is completed. A condition on paper does not protect a stream, a neighbour or a home unless it is carried out.

As flood and water conditions change with the climate, we need decisions that build resilience for the conditions ahead. The Board's role is to make the SCRD's priorities clear and ensure planners have sound procedures and training to review files thoroughly and apply those priorities consistently. That reduces risk to the environment, neighbouring properties and the community.

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Question 4: Water and Growth

What measures would you support to monitor water availability and changing water conditions on the Sunshine Coast, and how should that information be used when making decisions about growth and development?

YOUR RESPONSE

Water supply and watershed stewardship have to be managed as one system. The SCRD has a direct role in delivering water service, but that service depends on the whole water cycle: rainfall, streams, aquifers, water use, wastewater, drainage and healthy ecosystems.

I would work with the Board and other directors, First Nations, the Province, water users, scientists, conservation groups and residents on a long-term regional water-management plan. It should build on the SCRD's supply strategy of diversified sources, resilient infrastructure, efficiency and source protection, and connect those commitments to consistent monitoring of water quantity, quality, streamflow, aquifers and demand.

We should also pursue the tools available under the Water Sustainability Act, including water sustainability plans and water objectives, and connect the findings to the OCP, infrastructure planning and decisions about growth. Development should be guided by demonstrated water and wastewater capacity.

The Board should set the objectives, ask staff to develop implementation options and measures of progress, and review results regularly. This is ongoing stewardship of a shared resource, so we protect it and plan ahead rather than waiting for the next shortage.

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Question 5: Waste and Recycling

With the SCRD's landfill life now extended, what improvements, if any, would you support to recycling and waste diversion services in Roberts Creek, while balancing service improvements with equitable costs and fiscal sustainability?

YOUR RESPONSE

The SCRD already collects among the highest amounts of recyclables per person in B.C., largely through depot service. Curbside pickup would build on that effort and make recycling easier to access. The landfill's extended life gives us time to make a careful decision, but it shouldn't become a reason to keep postponing one.

We have studied this for years. In the SCRD's 2021 survey, 75% of Area D respondents supported curbside recycling. Across the four areas surveyed, 70% remained interested even when the estimated cost was stress-tested at \$70 a year without the Recycle BC subsidy. With the subsidy, the SCRD then estimated an additional \$30 to \$34 per household annually. Those are old estimates, and the SCRD says costs have risen.

I've reviewed local rate increases and Sechelt's collection rates. That comparison suggests the cost remains within the range residents considered.

Curbside would add a modest amount of diversion, so we should be honest about that and design the service carefully, including how to manage contamination and costs fairly. I would ask staff to firm up the current net cost, grants, safeguards and implementation options.

We already have direct evidence of demand and willingness to pay; I don't think we need to ask the same question again. If the updated numbers show no clear reason not to proceed, I would advocate that the Board move forward with providing the service.



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Question 6: Emergency Preparedness

What improvements would you support to strengthen emergency preparedness and resilience in Roberts Creek, including preparation for wildfires, flooding, earthquakes, prolonged power outages and other emergencies?

YOUR RESPONSE

Community resilience is built through everyday decisions, long before an emergency. Every SCRD decision about land use, infrastructure and services should consider how it will affect Roberts Creek's ability to withstand a crisis and reduce pressure on emergency responders.

For Roberts Creek, that means evacuation planning, reliable ways to alert residents, support for people who may need help leaving, and dependable water, roads, power and communications during wildfire, flooding, earthquakes or prolonged outages. It also means making sure development and infrastructure decisions account for known hazards and future conditions.

As Area D Director, I would work with the Board, staff, local responders, residents, First Nations and provincial partners to set clear resilience goals and turn them into practical actions. I would ask staff to identify responsibilities, costs and measures of progress, then test the plans through exercises and track whether gaps are fixed.

Preparedness should strengthen Roberts Creek's ability to act locally and connect that capacity to the wider regional support needed in a major emergency.

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Question 7: Affordable Housing

The Sunshine Coast is facing significant housing challenges. How would you approach the need for affordable housing while also considering Roberts Creek's rural character, infrastructure capacity, and environmental constraints?

YOUR RESPONSE

Affordable housing, Roberts Creek's character, infrastructure capacity and environmental protection are connected planning issues. The SCRD should set clear objectives for the housing Roberts Creek needs and where it can be supported.

Through OCP renewal, I would work with residents and housing providers to identify those needs and the areas with the water, wastewater, transportation and environmental capacity to accommodate them. Then the SCRD should clearly tell residents and developers what kinds of projects advance those objectives and how the SCRD can help make them happen.

When a proposal meets the community's housing goals and the necessary requirements, the SCRD should work with the developer from the outset: explain what is needed, coordinate the process, set clear service expectations and use its planning, servicing and partnership roles to help move the project forward.

Simply adding density to a plan does not deliver homes. As Director, I would work with the Board to set measurable housing objectives, ask staff to develop practical ways to achieve them, and track actual homes delivered. That is how we can support needed housing while respecting Roberts Creek's character and capacity.

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Question 8: Fiscal Responsibility

Roberts Creek residents are facing increasing costs for infrastructure, water, fire protection, waste management and other services. How would you balance the need to maintain and improve services with the impact of taxation on residents? What principles would guide your decisions about spending and taxation?

YOUR RESPONSE

Fiscal responsibility means managing each major service against a plan, not just reviewing its costs after they appear in the budget.

The Board should set the objective for each service and ask staff to develop a plan showing the work required, expected costs, and how we will measure whether the service is meeting its purpose. Staff should report regularly on actual costs and performance against that plan, explain any significant changes, and recommend adjustments.

That gives the Board a clear view of what each line item delivers, what is driving its costs, and whether the service is on track. If costs or performance start to drift, we can investigate and adjust early, before a manageable problem becomes a crisis or a much larger expense.

Those plans and measures also help the Board make informed decisions about service levels, priorities and taxation. Residents should be able to see what their taxes support, whether the service is delivering, and what action the Board is taking.

My principle is simple: set the objective, plan the service, monitor it regularly and correct course before problems become emergencies.



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Question 9: Accountability and Commitments

If elected, what specific commitments would you make to the residents of Roberts Creek, and how should residents assess your performance at the end of your term?

YOUR RESPONSE

Some of the most important work of past directors and residents continues to guide Roberts Creek because it was built into our plans and processes. Our OCP carries community priorities forward beyond any one director's term.

That is the stewardship I want to contribute to. I will listen to residents, bring Roberts Creek's priorities to the Board, and work with other directors to advance regional issues. I will help turn decisions into clear objectives, plans and measures, build on what past directors and residents have created, and strengthen it where needed. Each year, I will give residents a public update on the priorities I raised, decisions made, progress and setbacks, and next steps.

At the end of my term, residents should ask: Did I advance Roberts Creek's agency? Did I help address recurring problems in lasting ways? Can the community see what changed and what remains to be done?

If I do this well, the next director will inherit a stronger community vision, better processes and useful measures to guide decisions. They should be able to take up the work, improve it and carry that stewardship forward. That is the kind of lasting accountability I want to leave behind.

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Closing Statement

Someone asked earlier what my politics are. **TRUTH.**

Thank you for the thoughtful questions and for being here.

Tonight, I've tried to show not only what I would work on, but how I would do the work: listen, understand the problem, set clear objectives with the Board, build practical plans, and measure whether they are working.

Roberts Creek needs a strong voice at the Board, one that works with all nine directors to advance regional solutions while protecting our community's agency. I want to build on what residents and past directors have created, strengthen the processes that carry good work forward, and leave the next director a stronger foundation to build on.

As you decide, consider not only which priorities matter to you, but how you want them turned into lasting progress. I'd be honoured to earn your support on October 17. Now the **CHOICE** is **YOURS**.